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VERSILIAN STUDIOS

KARORYFER LECOLDS



OSIRIS PIANO

PRODUCT MANUAL

KVRDC'26



INTRODUCTION

Osiris was dead, cut up into hundreds of little scattered pieces. But for the 2026 KVRDC, the pieces were put together and live again!

Osiris Piano is a unique quiet piano, a worn Yamaha C2 grand recorded at half-stick with the soft pedal down and very low dynamics.

A pantheon of sound-shaping options were added, including Horus, Set, Shu, and Ptah. Each option shifts the piano in different directions from the dusty winds of Shu to the wild mascinations of Set.

DEVELOPMENT

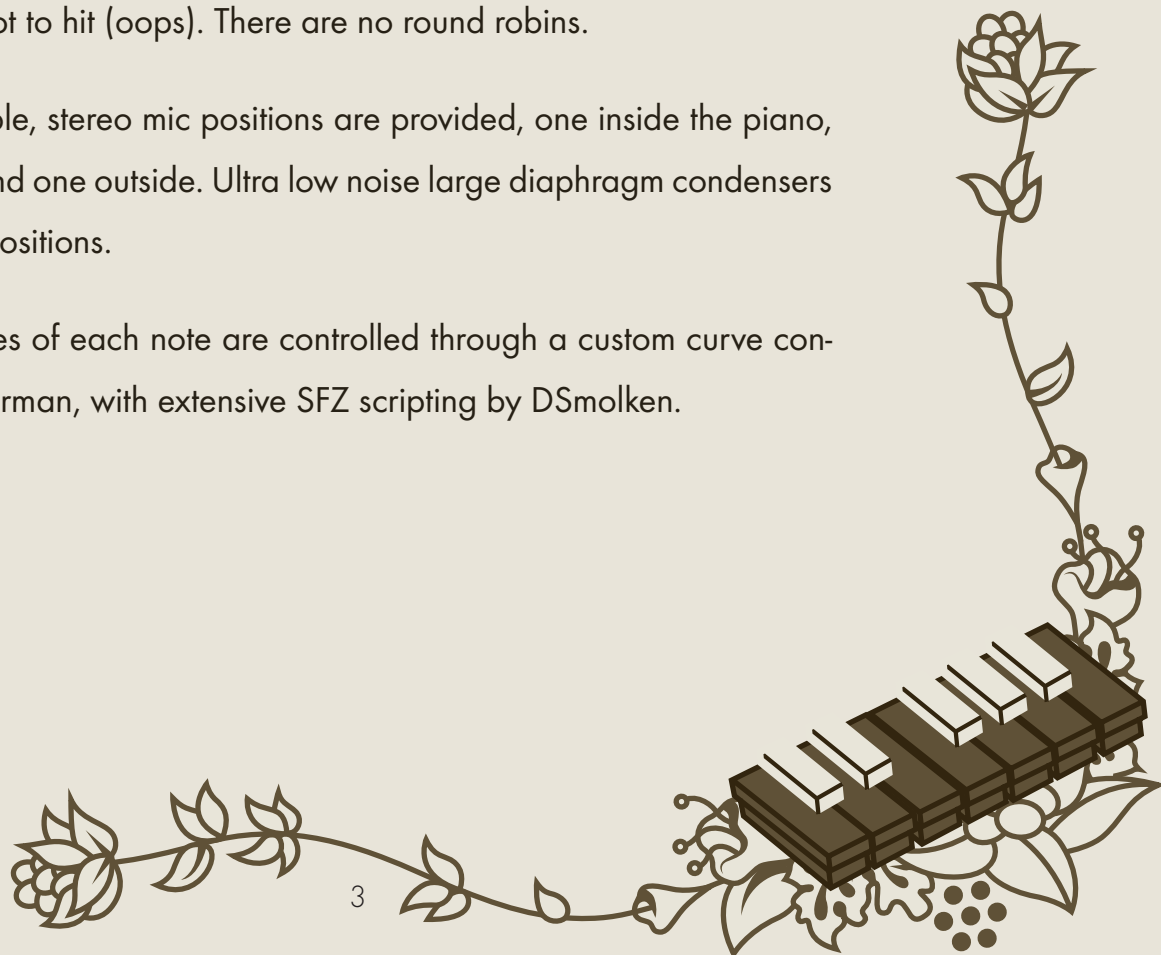
There are a lot of quiet piano sample libraries out there, so why make another? We wanted this one to be free of problems with noise or inconsistent dynamics.

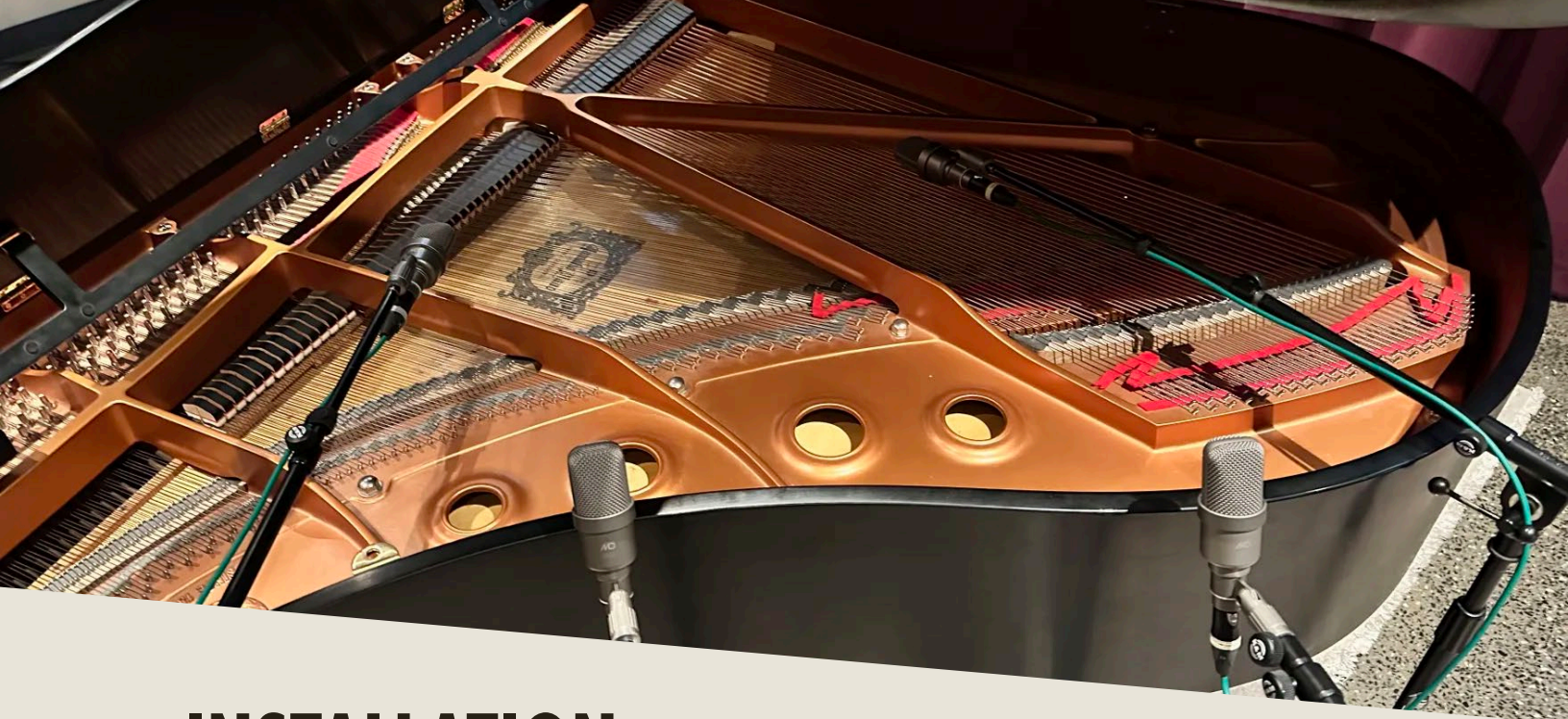
The piano was recorded in a low-noise studio environment through a Merging Hapi Mk II interface (**Hapi**, of course, being the god of the annual flooding of the Nile) with ADAv3 cards, and filtered using MAAT Digital software (**Ma'at**, of course, being the goddess of cosmic balance). Sample starts were cut by hand to ensure consistent latency throughout.

There are separate sample sets for sustain pedal up and sustain pedal down. There are two velocity layers sampled diatonically (meaning white keys only), except for B3 in the low velocity layer of the sustain pedal up samples, which we just forgot to hit (oops). There are no round robins.

Three mixable, stereo mic positions are provided, one inside the piano, one at the edge, and one outside. Ultra low noise large diaphragm condensers were used for all positions.

Release times of each note are controlled through a custom curve contributed by Jeff Learman, with extensive SFZ scripting by DSmolken.

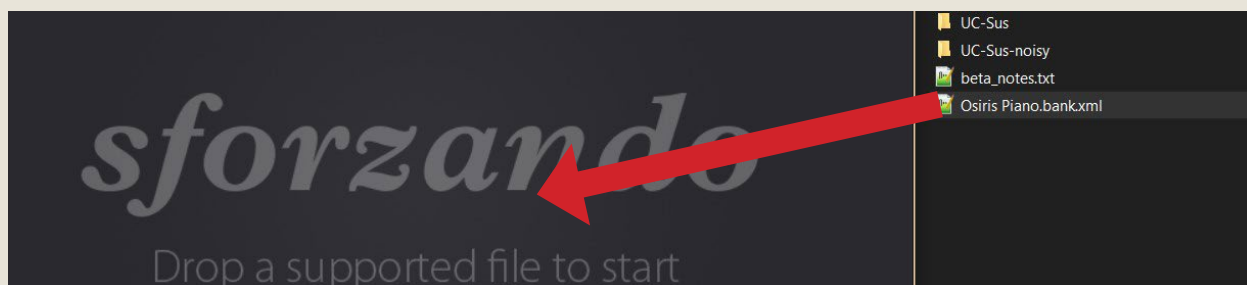




INSTALLATION

If you do not have Sforzando installed, install that first – version 1.981 or newer is required. After downloading and unzipping the Osiris Piano content into a folder, launch Sforzando. It can be launched either in standalone mode or as a plugin, though for registration purposes, standalone mode is recommended. Plugin mode can have issues with some DAWs and operating systems, while standalone mode is generally the safest option.

It is important that all the files stay in the same folder – changing the folder structure would require editing the SFZ files. Drag the Osiris Piano.bank.xml file onto the Sforzando interface.

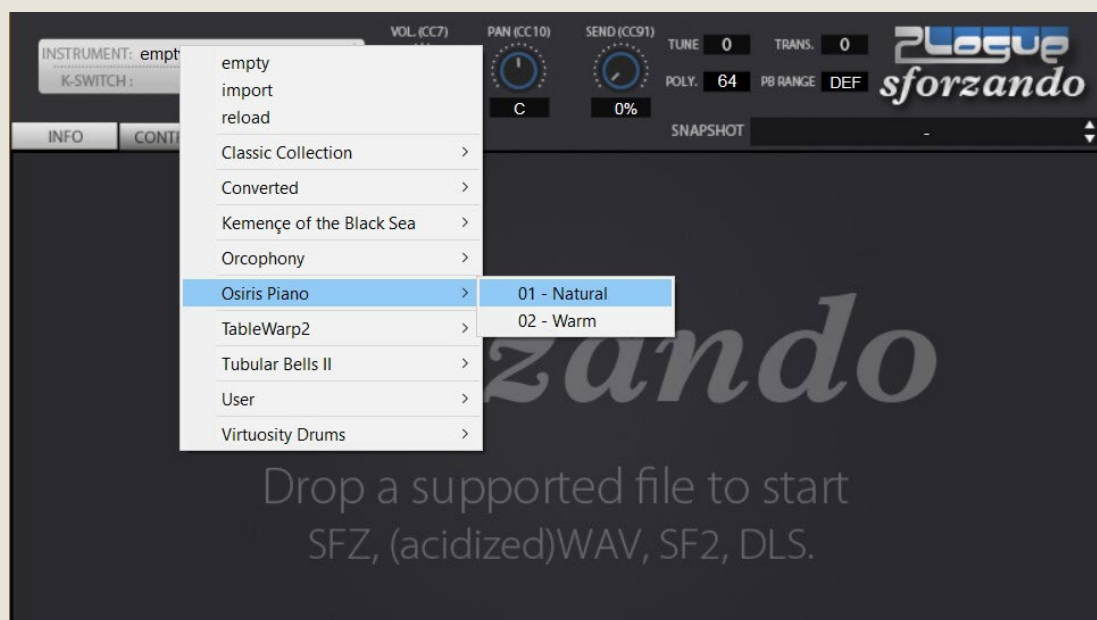


After providing administrator credentials, the library will be registered.

The SFZ files and FLAC files can be used without registration, but registration allows Osiris Piano to appear in Sforzando's instrument list, which allows the patches to be loaded with the GUI.

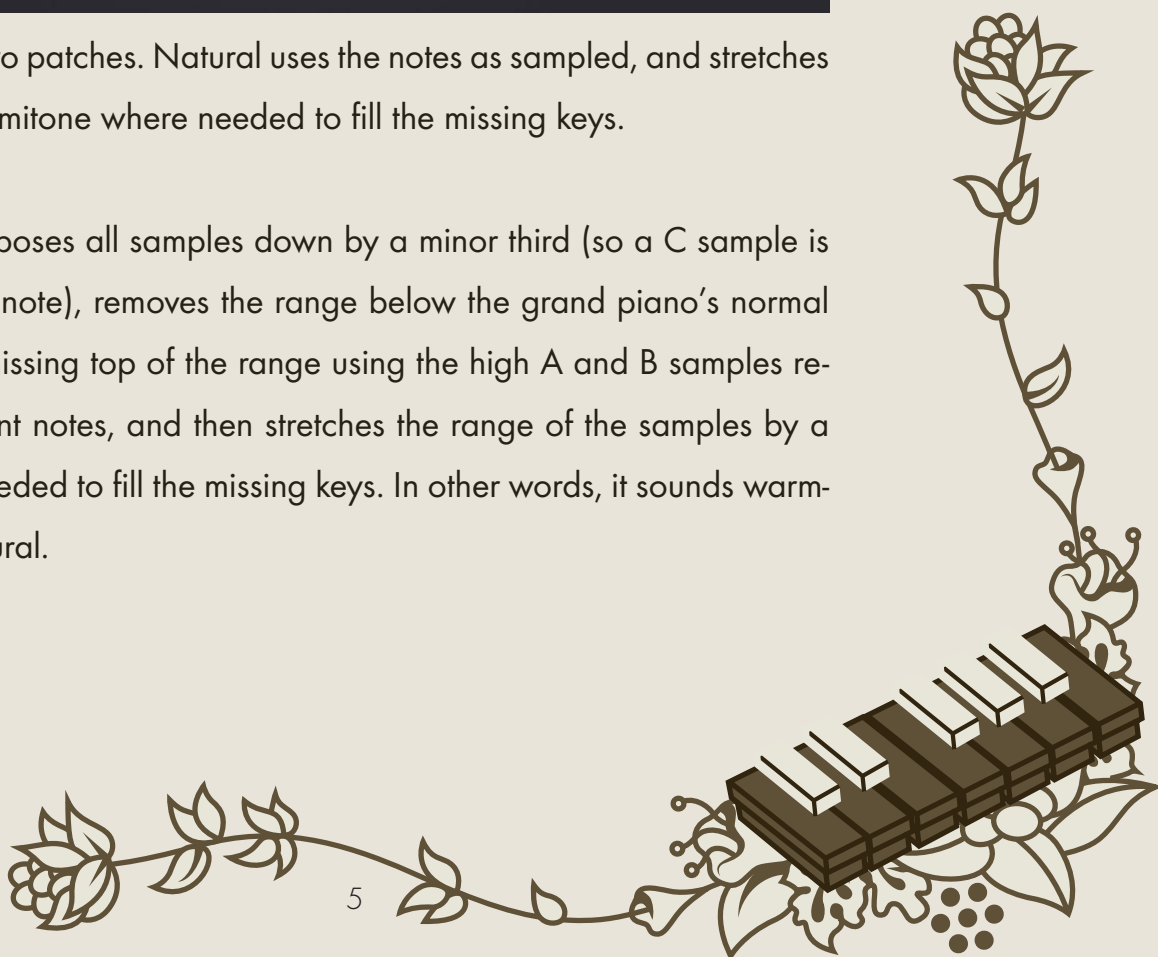
LOADING PATCHES

Once you have installed the library, you can load patches by clicking the 'Instrument' dropdown in Sforzando or ARIA, and selecting a program under 'Osiris Piano':



There are two patches. Natural uses the notes as sampled, and stretches their range by a semitone where needed to fill the missing keys.

Warm transposes all samples down by a minor third (so a C sample is used to play an A note), removes the range below the grand piano's normal low A, fills in the missing top of the range using the high A and B samples re-assigned to different notes, and then stretches the range of the samples by a semitone where needed to fill the missing keys. In other words, it sounds warmer, though less natural.





OPERATION

Once loaded in Sforzando or ARIA, the GUI will become available to you. This window will provide nearly everything you need to control and shape the sound of the instrument from tuning drums to controlling the stereo image to help it fit in your mix. In this section of the manual, I'll walk you through each part of the GUI and typical settings.





The top portion of the GUI is standard for all Sforzando libraries. Note that if you are using ARIA player, your GUI will look quite different here, as ARIA is designed to accomodate multiple patches at once.

Here you can select the Instrument loaded from among all libraries installed on your system. Also accessible are Volume (CC7), Pan (CC10), and [Reverb] Send (CC91) controls. The four tabs below; Info, Controls, Effects, and Settings change the active screen on the GUI.

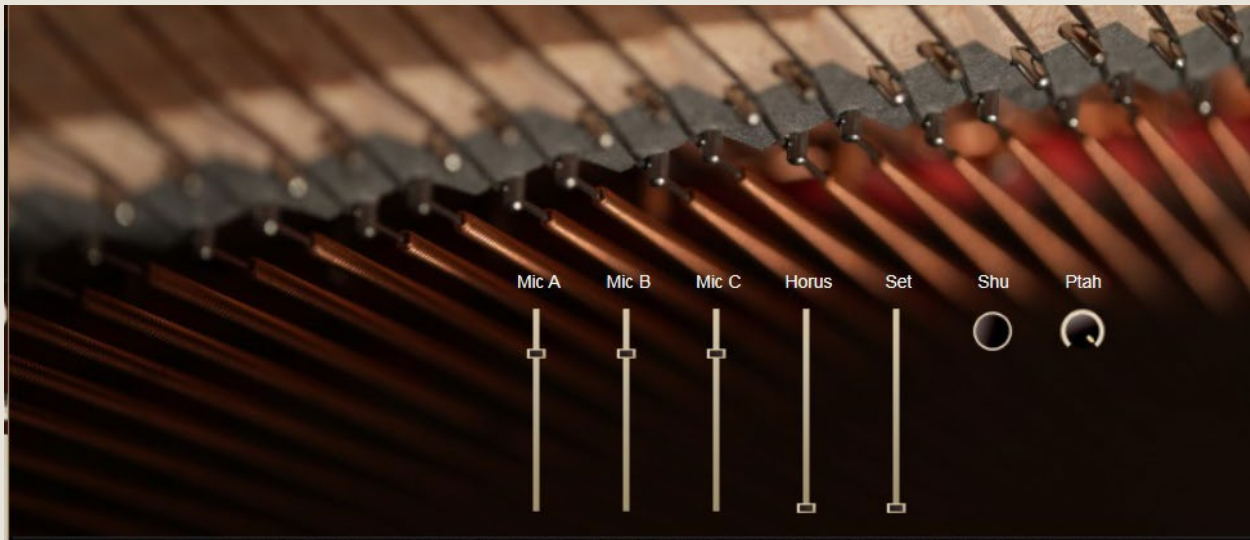
To the right, Tune provides adjustment in cents of the pitch of the library. This is not needed with the library, as there are individual tune controls for each drum provided separately (see later). Trans[pose] allows the incoming MIDI data to be transposed by halfsteps, which is generally not useful with drums.

Poly[phony] is the total number of voices available to the engine. It's probably a good idea to start by setting sforzando's polyphony voices to maximum, as the voices can accumulate quite quickly when playing with the sustain pedal down. With the three mics on, one note uses three polyphony voices, and with Horus above 50% it uses five.

PB Range controls the range that pitch bend will function.

Snapshot provides you a way to save your favorite mixes/settings locally for recal later. This is useful if you have a particular mix you like to use regularly across multiple songs or projects.





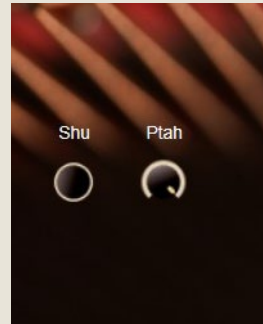
Select the 'Controls' tab and the above screen will appear.

Mics A, B and C are volume controls for the three mic positions. A is a Microtech Gefell M 940 inside the piano, B a Microtech Gefell M 930 Ts at the edge, and C a Microtech Gefell UM 930 in cardioid mode on the outside.

Horus adds two extra voices, for a sort of chorus but not really effect. From 0 to full blends in an extra copy of mic B transposed down a minor third in the natural patch (or an untransposed copy in the warm patch). From the midpoint to full it also blends in another copy of mic B transposed down a tritone. This adds warmth and richness, but using this "transposition trick" to add unison to a piano is highly heretical, which is why the control is named Horus.

Setting Set above zero tunes mic A upwards slightly, and mics B and C down by even smaller (though differing) amounts. So, with only one mic on, it just makes the whole piano drift out of tune, but with all three mics at roughly the same level it makes the piano sound like the strings are out of tune, which of course makes sense as Set is the god of discord, perhaps even dischord. Try cranking it and running the piano through heavy distortion.

Shu selects between the denoised (Shu off) and natural non-denoised (Shu on) sample sets, which of course makes sense as Shu is the god of air and wind. The non-denoised samples are still pretty quiet so the effect is subtle unless there's significant gain in the signal chain, for example when running the piano through heavy distortion.



Ptah controls how much latency and pre-note hammer noise there is. It's an offset control, so the higher Ptah is set, the more pre-note noise there will be, latency will also increase, which of course makes sense as Ptah is the god of blacksmiths and overengineering. With Ptah set at zero, the first 1200 samples of each file are skipped. Readers who are good at math have realized that this is a different amount of time for transposed samples, and with Horus at max, changing Ptah will have an audible effect on the phase relationship of the voices, especially in the lower register.

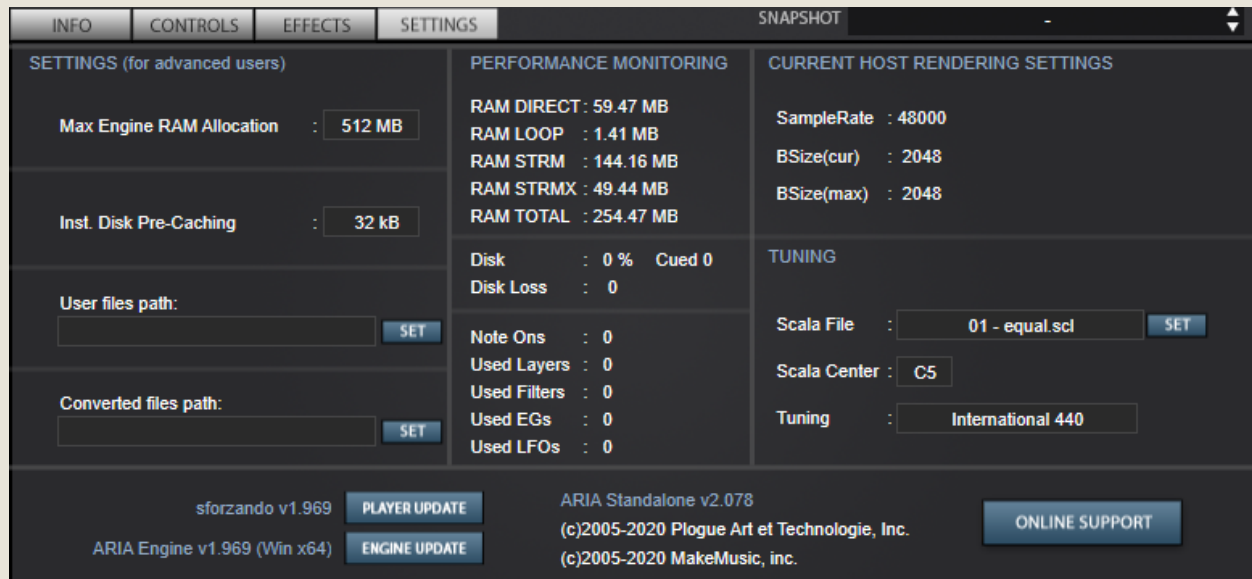


At the bottom of the window is a virtual keyboard and pedals.

The sustain pedal should function as a sustain pedal, including for half-pedaling. Notes hit while the sustain pedal is down trigger the sustain-pedal-on sample set, while notes hit while the sustain pedal is up trigger the sustain-pedal-off sample set.

With the soft pedal on, only the lowest velocity layer is used. The samples were all recorded with the soft pedal down in reality.





The Effects tab (not pictured) provides a generic algorithmic reverb.

In the Settings tab are some generic metrics about the instrument's behavior and some settings to tweak performance. Of most importance perhaps here is Max Engine RAM Allocation. On a modern system with at least 4 GB of RAM, I would suggest setting this to 2 GB to ensure the engine can load all the samples it needs to into RAM.

In the center column you can see the current RAM, disk, and engine usage. Over time, as notes are played, the total RAM usage will increase to a maximum of approximately 1.3 GB.



CONTINUOUS CONTROLLERS

The following MIDI CC's are hard-wired in Osiris Piano. If you experience strange, unusual behavior or the piano keeps 'resetting' to an odd state, ensure no undesirable signals are being transmitted on these controllers.

MASTER CC LIST - OSIRIS PIANO

Pedals

64	Sustain Pedal
67	Soft Pedal

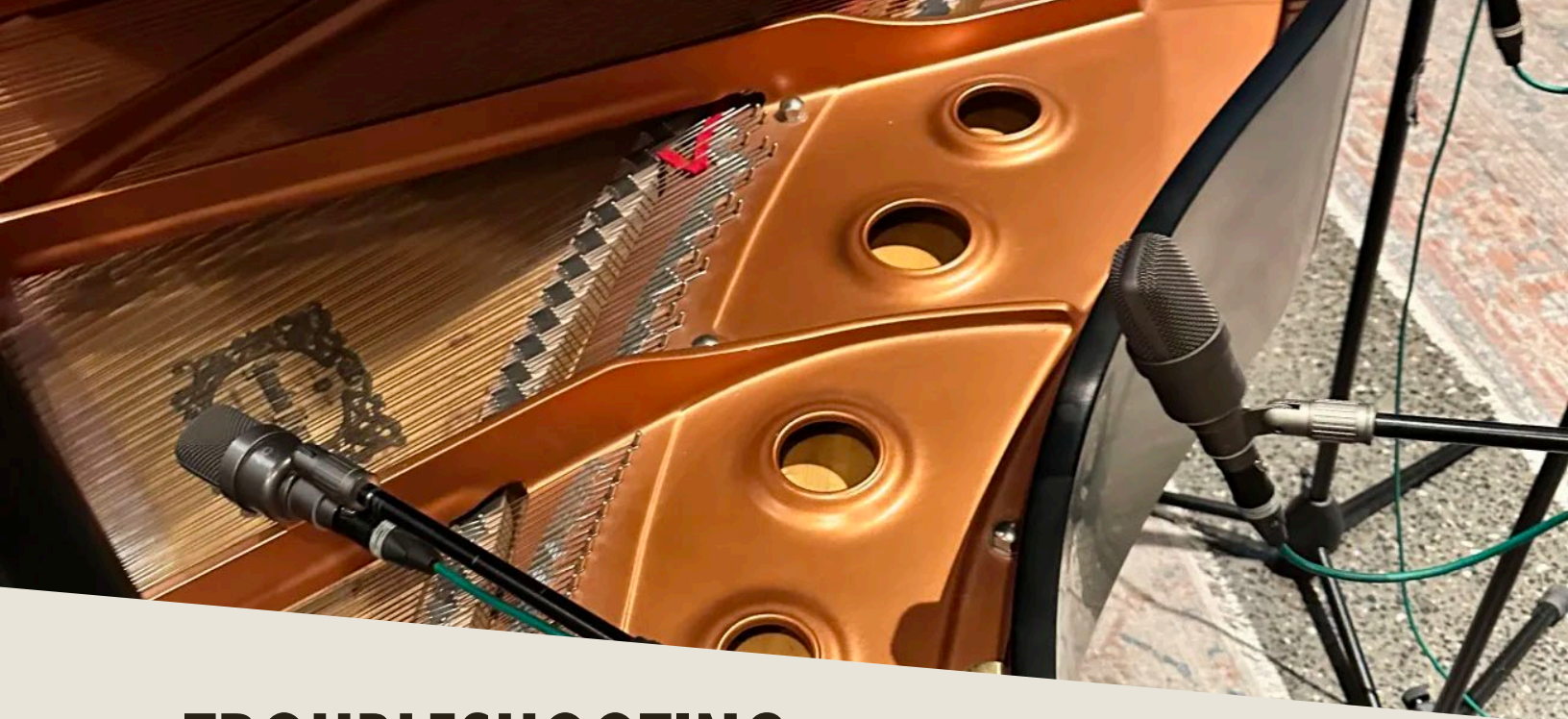
Effects/UI

70	Shu
73	Ptah
93	Horus
94	Set

Mic Settings

100	Mic A (level)
101	Mic B (level)
102	Mic C (level)





TROUBLESHOOTING

If you are experiencing issues with the library, there are a few steps you can try to resolve the issues before contacting us. Below is a list of common possible problems and 'home remedies' that will work to fix them.

1. Samples could not be found warning.

Generally the best solution is to re-extract the files from the .zip archive, or re-download the archive. Never move any of the folders or files in the 'Osiris Piano' folder to another location as this will break the program. If you wish to move the library, move the entire Osiris Piano folder itself with everything left inside as-is, then activate in Sforzando.

3. Library fails to register in Sforzando/ARIA.

Click to the right of "Instrument:" then click 'import'. Manually navigate to and select the .bank.xml file and proceed. Note that on some operating systems, file extensions are hidden, so the bank file may appear as simply .bank.

Make sure you update Sforzando/ARIA to the latest version. You can do this by going to the settings tab and selecting 'Player Update', then 'Engine Update' as well.

4. Instrument takes a long time to load.

On Windows 10 & 11 devices or devices with 'realtime protection' anti-malware systems, such systems will attempt to scan the literally thousands of samples that Sforzando/ARIA needs to load before letting Sforzando/ARIA load them. It is strongly advised that you at least temporarily disable such 'realtime protection' systems while loading libraries, or set up an exemption for your folder or drive of sample libraries.

It is always recommended to use a solid state drive (SSD) from which to stream samples. A 256 GB external drive can be had for the price of a decent dinner with a drink and can hold this very library nearly 200 times over, while also speeding up load times significantly vs. a mechanical hard drive.

5. Instrument won't respond to MIDI input.

Make sure your DAW or standalone Sforzando/ARIA is receiving MIDI from your device, then ensure that the MIDI channel is set to match.

If you have any other issues, drop us a line at contact@versilstudios.net.





CREDITS

Recording, editing, and photographs by Versilian Studios.

SFZ and GUI by Karoryfer Samples.

Release time keytracking implemented by Jeff Learman, who was also an extremely helpful and thorough tester.

Half-pedaling sfz from VI Control post by dore_m, via kinwie's open-source Splendid Grand.

Deities by Kemet.

Horus by Games Workshop.